

5.3.1 Changing the size of an image

To resize an image, in the Image menu on the top of the screen, select Scale Image. You can then specify the image size in centimetres, inches, or other units or as a percentage of the original, or even in pixels. (You will find a locked symbol adjacent to the height and width box. This is to preserve the aspect ratio.) For most purposes, you can leave the X-Y resolution as it is at 74 pixels/inch. For best quality, set the interpolation to cubic.

A word of caution, though—when you increase the size of the image, you will suffer some loss in quality. With a good image, you can go up to 200 per cent—anything beyond that will be noticeably hazy.

5.3.2 Cropping an image

Not all of us are photography experts. Often, the background will be more prominent than the subject itself! If you want to eliminate an unwanted area of the image, just use the crop function: keep your image window and The GIMP window open. In The GIMP options, use the select tool—the first tool in the list. Choose the **Select** tool, and click and drag on the part of your image that you want to keep. The selection will now be showing in the rectangle. Now go to **Image > Crop Image**. That's it! If your selection was not proper, then just Undo it by pressing **[Ctrl] + [Z]** and redo the process.

5.3.3 Reducing the file size of an image

Let's say you have want to e-mail a picture taken using a digicam, and the file size is too high, some 1 MB. You can try to compress the image using a slightly lesser-quality setting. The eye may not be able to make out the difference at all. But just how much compression you can apply is something you have to decide by trial and error, as every image's quality is different. It could be an already compressed image, or it might be digitally modified, which increases distortion. So there is no rule of thumb while deciding on the amount of compression you can apply.